

ECON 2I03: Financial Economics

Spring 2026 (online)

Instructor Information

Instructor Name: Rizwan Tahir

Email: tahirr1@mcmaster.ca

Office hours: Posted on Avenue to Learn (A2L)

Course Information

Lectures: see Avenue to Learn (A2L) or MOSAIC for times and classroom information

Labs: No

Tutorials: No

Course Dates: 2026/05/04- 2026/06/19

Units: 3.0

Course Delivery Mode: Online

Course Description

This course focuses on the financial sector. Topics include the role of capital markets in facilitating investment and growth, bond markets, & stock markets. It analyses behavior of interest rates and discusses Banking and the Management of Financial Institutions.

Meeting Details

The course contents are **delivered online**. Weekly modules are designed based on each chapter of the textbook. Each module includes lecture slides, lecture video, MyLab assignment and a quiz. You will have the flexibility to review the slides and watch the lecture video at your own pace during the week.

Live Course Overview Session: (Optional)

This overview session is scheduled for **Tuesday, May 5th from 1:30 pm to 2:30 pm.**

You can attend this live introductory session by using the zoom link that will be posted on the avenue.

Weekly Office hours through zoom, every Tuesday from 1:30 pm to 2:30 pm

Important Links

- [Mosaic](#)
- [Avenue to Learn](#)

- [Student Accessibility Services - Accommodations](#)
- [McMaster University Library](#)
- [eReserves](#)

Course Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course students should be able to:
Understand the primary functions of the Financial System

- Understand the structure of the Financial Markets
- Understand time value of money
- Understand how to value bonds & stocks
- Explain the Financial Market Instruments
- Understand time value of money and Valuation of Financial assets
- Explain the Functions of Financial Intermediaries
- Explain the types of Financial Intermediaries
- Explain Regulation of Financial Markets
- Explain the role of financial regulatory authorities
- Explain the role of central banking

Materials and Fees

This course is part of the Immediate Access Program in collaboration with the Campus Store. The required materials are used extensively for learning and assessments. You will receive digital access to these materials via Avenue to Learn on the first day of class at a discounted price of \$104.95.

Title: The Economics of Money, Banking and Financial Markets **(MyLab + Pearson eText)**

ISBN: **9780137842476**

Authors: Fredric S. Mishkin

Publisher: Pearson

Publication Date: 2023

Edition: 8th

Cost: \$104.95

Additional Text:

Corporate Finance, 3rd Canadian Edition, by Jonathan Berk, Peter Demarzo & David Stangeland, 2015, Pearson

(selected chapters provided on the A2L)

Course Evaluation – Overview

Component	Weight
Quizzes (7 Quizzes)	10%
MyLab Assignments	10%
Term Test-1	20%

Term Test-2	20%
Final Exam	40%

Course Evaluation – Details

Quizzes

Quizzes will be administered through Achieve but will be available via Avenue to Learn. There will be a total of 7 quizzes. Each quiz will be available from 9 am to 11 pm on Mondays or Fridays.

Test #1 & Test #2

Both tests would be available on the avenue on **Tuesdays from 1:30 pm to 2:30 pm**. Each test is of 60 minutes duration. The material for each test is outlined below

Assignments:

Available through MyEconLab. It is an online learning and assessment tool. It provides ample opportunity to practice concepts, diagrams, and algebraic problems consistent with the textbook readings. There is a total of seven (7) weekly assignments. Each assignment will be based on weekly contents.

Final Exam

The final exam will be online through Avenue on **Thursday, June 18th from 130 pm to 330 pm**. You will have 90 minutes and the exam is cumulative.

Grading Scale

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Grade	Equivalent Grade Point	Equivalent Percentages
A+	12	90-100

Grade	Equivalent Grade Point	Equivalent Percentages
A	11	85-89
A-	10	80-84
B+	9	77-79
B	8	73-76
B-	7	70-72
C+	6	67-69
C	5	63-66
C-	4	60-62
D+	3	57-59
D	2	53-56
D-	1	50-52
F	0	0-49

Weekly Course Schedule (and/or important dates)

Dates	Topics/Readings	Quizzes on Avenue
Module 1 May 4 th to May 8 th	<i>Introduction:</i> <i>Chapters 1, 2 & 3 (RT)*</i> The Time Value of Money Chapter 4 (AT)**	Quiz #1 Covers chapters 1,2 &3 (RT) & 4 (AT): May 11 MyLab Assignment-1[May 5 to May 10)

Module 2 May 11 th to May 15 th	Basic Valuation Valuing Bonds Chapter 6 (AT) Financial Markets Understanding Interest rates The behaviour of interest rate Chapter 5 (RT)	Quiz #2 Covers chapter 5 (RT) & 6 (AT): May 18 MyLab Assignment-2[May 11 to May 17]
Module 3 May 18 th to May 22 nd	TEST # 1 Covers chapters 1,2,3(RT) & 4, 6 (AT) The Risk and Term structure of interest rate Chapter 6(RT) Valuing Stocks Chapter 7 (AT)	Quiz #3 Covers chapter 6 (RT): May 25 MyLab Assignment-3[May 18 to May 24]
Module 4 May 25 th to May 29 th	Financial Institutions Chapter 8 (RT) Financial Institutions ... Continue Chapters 9 (RT)	Quiz #4 Covers chapter 7 (AT) & 8(RT) June 1 st MyLab Assignment-4[May 25 to May 31] Quiz #5 Covers chapter 9 (RT): June 5 MyLab Assignment-5[June 1 to June 4]
Module 5 June 1 st to June 5 th	Financial Institutions ... Continue Chapters 11 (RT) TEST # 2 Covers chapters 7(AT) & 5,6 & 8 (RT)	Quiz #6 (Covers chapter 11, 14: June 8 MyLab Assignment-6[June 5 to June 7]
Week 6 June 8 th to June 12 th	Central Banking Chapter 14, 15, 16(RT)	Quiz #7 (Covers chapter 15, 16: June 15 MyLab Assignment-7[June 8 to June 14]
Week 7 June 15 th to June 19 th	Final Exam (Cumulative)	

Important Dates

Last day withdrawing from courses without failure by default: Monday, June 1

Test # 1 (60 minutes) Tuesday, May 19th, from 130 pm to 230 pm [available on the A2L]

Test # 2(60 minutes) Tuesday, June 2nd, from 130 pm to 230 pm [available on the A2L]

Final Exam (80 minutes) Thursday, June 18th from 130 pm to 330 pm [available on the A2L]

Late Assignments

Both MyLab assignments and Avenue quizzes must be submitted by the due dates. There is no option of submitting after the due date.

Absences, Missed Work or Illness

- There will be no makeup quizzes or makeup tests
- If you miss a test or quiz, you will get a grade of zero unless you complete and submit a McMaster Student Absence Form (MSAF) which can be found at <https://www.mcmaster.ca/msaf/>
- With approved MASF, weight of the missed quiz or test will be shifted towards final exam.

Turnitin.com

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For students using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. A2L, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

Students who do not wish their work to be submitted through the plagiarism detection software must inform the Instructor before the assignment is due. No penalty will be assigned to a student who does not submit work to the plagiarism detection software. All submitted work is subject to normal verification that standards of academic integrity have been upheld (e.g., on-line search, other software, etc.). For more details about McMaster's use of Turnitin.com please go to www.mcmaster.ca/academicintegrity.

Course Modification

The instructor and university reserve the right to modify elements of the course during the term. The university may change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances. If either type of modification becomes necessary, reasonable notice and communication with the students will be given with an explanation and the opportunity to comment on changes. It is the responsibility of the student to check their McMaster email and course websites weekly during the term and to note any changes.

Generative AI

Students are not permitted to use generative AI in this course. In alignment with [McMaster academic integrity policy](#), it "shall be an offence knowingly to ... submit academic work for assessment that was purchased or acquired from another source". This includes work created by generative AI tools. Also state in the policy is the following, "Contract Cheating is the act of "outsourcing of student work to third parties" (Lancaster & Clarke, 2016, p. 639) with or

without payment.” Using Generative AI tools is a form of contract cheating. Charges of academic dishonesty will be brought forward to the Office of Academic Integrity.

APPROVED ADVISORY STATEMENTS

Academic Integrity

You are expected to exhibit honesty and use ethical behaviour in all aspects of the learning process. Academic credentials you earn are rooted in principles of honesty and academic integrity. **It is your responsibility to understand what constitutes academic dishonesty.**

Academic dishonesty is to knowingly act or fail to act in a way that results or could result in unearned academic credit or advantage. This behaviour can result in serious consequences, e.g. the grade of zero on an assignment, loss of credit with a notation on the transcript (notation reads: “Grade of F assigned for academic dishonesty”), and/or suspension or expulsion from the university. For information on the various types of academic dishonesty please refer to the [Academic Integrity Policy](https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/), located at <https://secretariat.mcmaster.ca/university-policies-proceduresguidelines/>

The following illustrates only three forms of academic dishonesty:

- plagiarism, e.g. the submission of work that is not one’s own or for which other credit has been obtained.
- improper collaboration in group work.
- copying or using unauthorized aids in tests and examinations.

Authenticity / Plagiarism

Some courses may use a web-based service (Turnitin.com) to reveal authenticity and ownership of student submitted work. For courses using such software, students will be expected to submit their work electronically either directly to Turnitin.com or via an online learning platform (e.g. Avenue to Learn, etc.) using plagiarism detection (a service supported by Turnitin.com) so it can be checked for academic dishonesty.

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Email Communication

Effective September 1, 2010, it is the policy of the Faculty of Social Sciences that all e-mail communication sent from students to instructors (including Tasks), and from students to staff, must originate from the student's own McMaster University e-mail account. This policy protects confidentiality and confirms the identity of the student. It is the student's responsibility to ensure that communication is sent to the university from a McMaster account. If an instructor becomes aware that a communication has come from an alternate address, the instructor may not reply at his/her/their discretion.

Courses with an On-line Element

Some courses may use on-line elements (e.g. e-mail, Avenue to Learn, LearnLink, web pages, capa, Moodle, ThinkingCap, etc.). Students should be aware that, when they access the electronic components of a course using these elements, private information such as first and last names, usernames for the McMaster e-mail accounts, and program affiliation may become apparent to all other students in the same course. The available information is dependent on the technology used. Continuation in a course that uses on-line elements will be deemed consent to this disclosure. If you have any questions or concerns about such disclosure, please discuss this with the course instructor.

Online Proctoring

Some courses may use online proctoring software for tests and exams. This software may require students to turn on their video camera, present identification, monitor and record their computer activities, and/or lock/restrict their browser or other applications/software during tests or exams. This software may be required to be installed before the test/exam begins.

Conduct Expectations

As a McMaster student, you have the right to experience, and the responsibility to demonstrate, respectful and dignified interactions within all of our living, learning and working communities. These expectations are described in the [Code of Student Rights & Responsibilities](#) (the "Code"). All students share the responsibility of maintaining a positive environment for the academic and personal growth of all McMaster community members, **whether in person or online.**

It is essential that students be mindful of their interactions online, as the Code remains in effect in virtual learning environments. The Code applies to any interactions that adversely affect, disrupt, or interfere with reasonable participation in University activities. Student disruptions or behaviours that interfere with university functions on online platforms (e.g. use of Avenue 2 Learn, WebEx or Zoom for delivery), will be taken very seriously and will be investigated. Outcomes may include restriction or removal of the involved students' access to these platforms.

Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities

Students with disabilities who require academic accommodation must contact [Student Accessibility Services](#) (SAS) at 905-525-9140 ext. 28 652 or sas@mcmaster.ca to make arrangements with a Program Coordinator. For further information, consult McMaster University's [Academic Accommodation of Students with Disabilities](#) policy.

Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work

In the event of an absence for medical or other reasons, students should review and follow the [Policy on Requests for Relief for Missed Academic Term Work](#).

Academic Accommodation for Religious, Indigenous, or Spiritual Observances (RISO)

Students requiring academic accommodation based on religious, indigenous or spiritual observances should follow the procedures set out in the [RISO](#) policy. Students should submit their request to their Faculty Office ***normally within 10 working days*** of the beginning of term in which they anticipate a need for accommodation or to the Registrar's Office prior to their examinations. Students should also contact their instructors as soon as possible to make alternative arrangements for classes, assignments, and tests.

Copyright and Recording

Students are advised that lectures, demonstrations, performances, and any other course material provided by an instructor include copyright protected works. The Copyright Act and copyright law protect every original literary, dramatic, musical and artistic work, **including lectures** by University instructors.

The recording of lectures, tutorials, or other methods of instruction may occur during a course. Recording may be done by either the instructor for the purpose of authorized distribution, or by a student for the purpose of personal study. Students should be aware that their voice and/or image may be recorded by others during the class. Please speak with the instructor if this is a concern for you.

Extreme Circumstances

The University reserves the right to change the dates and deadlines for any or all courses in extreme circumstances (e.g., severe weather, labour disruptions, etc.). Changes will be communicated through regular McMaster communication channels, such as McMaster Daily News, Avenue to Learn and/or McMaster email.